



Roanoke Insurance Group Inc.

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January 18, 2019

Submitted via email to Secretary@FMC.gov

Federal Maritime Commission
Attn: Rachel E. Dickon, Secretary
800 North Capitol Street NW
Washington, DC 20573-0001

RE: **Docket No. 18-11**
RIN 3072-AC73 83 FR 64502
Public Comments regarding proposed changes to 46 CFR Part 515

Dear Ms. Dickon,

Roanoke Insurance Group Inc. (Roanoke) is an insurance broker specialist providing insurance products and surety bonds for shippers, importers, exporters, and businesses involved with the domestic and international movement of goods. The OTI bond is one of the bonds we provide. Ever since the FMC required evidence of financial responsibility of freight forwarders and NVOCCs, Roanoke has provided bonds and managed claims arising under those bonds, ensuring that parties regulated by the FMC are easily able to conduct their operations while giving the FMC and the shipping public excellent assurances of statutory compliance. The FMC regulations, especially the bond-related regulations, do affect how Roanoke and its underwriters operate and interact with the FMC, OTIs, and to a lesser extent the shipping public. We welcome this opportunity the FMC has extended to provide comment.

We endorse and support the minor administrative modifications the FMC is proposing to Part 515. We believe the closer integration between the Tariff and Licensing units during the licensing process, specifically adopting a rule that the FMC will not issue the license until the financial responsibility and tariff are in place, is beneficial to the industry. Further, Roanoke has no objection to the additional reporting information added to §515.23.

We hope that the FMC will move forward with its proposed regulatory changes. We believe the changes will enhance how the Commission operates and provide some better clarity for the industry.

Best regards,
ROANOKE INSURANCE GROUP INC.

/s/ Matthew L. Zehner
Vice President – Surety Information and Analysis
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